

Redesigning Software with an AI Agent

Day 2A: Customer Goals and Competitive Advantage

Purpose. AI agents may change software from tools that help people work into systems that can pursue business goals. Your task is to redesign a software product around a customer goal and decide whether AI strengthens or weakens the company that sells it today.

Instructions. Work with your team. Do not use an LLM or outside sources. Use your experience with the product and the ideas from class.

You have **12 minutes** to prepare. Choose one person to give a **90-second report**. The instructor will invite two or three teams to present.

Part 1: Choose a Product and Customer Goal

Choose a software product that your team knows well.

Examples:

Zoom Microsoft Teams Slack Notion Shopify Canva Moodle

Describe the customer’s real goal, not the product feature.

- **Not:** “Zoom video meetings”
- **Better:** “Help teams make decisions and complete follow-up tasks”
- **Not:** “Salesforce customer records”
- **Better:** “Help sales teams find opportunities and close deals faster”

Customer goal:

Part 2: Design the AI Agent

Design the simplest AI agent that could help achieve this goal.

Question	Your answer
What information does the agent need?	
What decisions can the agent make?	
What actions can the agent take?	
Where must a person approve or intervene?	
What happens when the agent is wrong?	

Part 3: Does AI Strengthen or Weaken the Company?

AI agents may reduce the value of some parts of software while increasing the value of others.

May become less important

- interfaces, screens, and menus;
- fixed workflows that users must follow;
- software features that only organize information.

May become more important

- proprietary data and records;
- integration with important workflows;
- permissions, trust, and auditability;
- relationships with existing customers.

Identify:

1. One advantage that becomes **less important**.
2. One advantage that becomes **more important**.
3. Why does each change happen?

Final Strategic Judgment

Choose the statement that best describes the future of the company:

1. Vulnerable to disruption

An AI-native competitor could replace much of the existing product.

2. Still necessary

The company controls important data, workflows, permissions, or customer trust.

3. Strengthened

Customers prefer an AI agent from a company they already trust to manage important information and actions.

Your Team's Report

Your Team's Report

Prepare a 90-second report answering three questions:

1. What customer goal does your AI agent pursue, and what actions can it take?
2. Where must a person approve, stop, or correct the agent?
3. Is the company vulnerable to disruption, still necessary, or strengthened? What assumption matters most for your answer?

Questions to Guide Discussion

- Does the agent depend on information or permissions controlled by the existing company?
- Could a new competitor easily copy those advantages?
- What is the biggest risk if the agent acts incorrectly?

The goal is not to predict that all software companies will disappear. The goal is to identify which parts of software become less valuable and which become more valuable when software can take action.